Why do my rights differ with my locality?

Was it my fault?

Was it my fault to be born as a woman in a world

Run on a system created to favour men,

So much so that if I had parents who thought different,

I would not exist for this moment in narration.

Was I too ambitious?

For wanting to exist as I was?

For not wanting someone to tell me to 'cover up' or smile more?

Why is the decision to burn and inflict pain on my body

Rather hold the perps accountable?

They say beauty lies in the eyes of the beholder,

Maybe so does shame.

Coz I never felt the need to cover up or inflict pain on myself to be socially accepted

I never felt ashamed

Until someone said I ought to be.

Coz someone decided that the mere existence of a woman is too much or too less

And always needs to be policed.

Was it my fault? -

YES.

Screamed the teary eyed woman in front of me,

Before I could go on any further.